

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2009

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard
Retrieved	8 August 2026
Records	21 House, 18 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. Paycheck Fairness Act

	H.R. 12 · January 9, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 256 NAYs 163

The Paycheck Fairness Act would require employers to demonstrate that wage gaps between men and women doing the same work are truly a result of factors other than sex, and would prohibit retaliation against workers who share salary information or inquire about their employer's wage practices. It also amends the Equal Pay Act to allow the same remedies and class-action procedures available for other civil rights claims.

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/paycheck-fairness-act
--------	---

2. Lilly Ledbetter Fair Pay Act of 2009 and Paycheck Fairness Act Amendments

	H.R. 11 · January 9, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 247 NAYs 171

Ledbetter v. Goodyear Tire and Rubber. Lilly Ledbetter, a Goodyear Tire Co. supervisor, did not learn that she was being paid substantially less than her male colleagues, in violation of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, until she retired after 19 years on the job. The Supreme Court ruled that Ledbetter lost the right to sue 180 days after she received her first paycheck. Prior to this decision, other courts had ruled that each paycheck started the 180-day clock over because each check was fresh evidence of discrimination.

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/lilly-ledbetter-fair-pay-act-2009-and-paycheck-fairness-act-amendments
--------	---

3. Children's Health Insurance Program Reauthorization Act of 2009

	H.R. 2 · January 14, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 289 NAYs 139

Since the Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP) was enacted in 1997 with broad bipartisan support, the number of uninsured children has dropped by one-third, even as the rate of uninsured adults has increased steadily. The CHIP reauthorization bill preserves coverage for more than six million children while extending coverage to nearly four million more uninsured children.

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/childrens-health-insurance-program-reauthorization-act-2009
--------	---

4. American Recovery and Reinvestment Act of 2009

	H.R. 1 · January 28, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 244 NAYs 188

As a first priority of the Obama administration, and a key step toward rebuilding an economy that works for all Americans, the House passed the American Recovery and Reinvestment Act. The investment provisions of the bill are specifically targeted to creating and maintaining jobs, and make major investments in transportation, infrastructure, state Medicaid and other health care programs, education and housing assistance, and energy-efficiency projects.

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/american-recovery-and-reinvestment-act-2009
--------	---

5. Omnibus Appropriations Act, 2009

	H.R. 1105 · February 25, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 245 NAYs 178

The omnibus spending bill combines nine funding bills for several federal agencies, including the Department of Labor and Department of Education. The bill included funding for critical labor and health and safety programs and would fund government operations through Sept. 30, 2009.

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/omnibus-appropriations-act-2009
--------	---

6. The Helping Families Save Their Homes Act of 2009

	H.R. 1106 · March 5, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 234 NAYs 191
	The Helping Families Save Their Homes Act of 2009 will, among other provisions, allow bankruptcy judges to modify mortgage loans for distressed homeowners. This provision is a logical fix to assist thousands of working families to restructure their home mortgages much in the same way as investors and those who have second homes do now.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/helping-families-save-their-homes-act-2009

7. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

	H.R. 1262 · March 12, 2009
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 140 NAYs 284
	This amendment by Rep. Connie Mack (R-Fla.) to the TK TK would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws

8. Joint FY2010 Budget Resolution

	S.Con.Res. 16 · April 29, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 233 NAYs 193
	The House and Senate jointly agreed to \$3.56 trillion budget resolution for fiscal year 2010. The resolution allows modest increases in funding to housing, education, job training, safety and health care programs that have been consistently cut during the past eight years. The resolution assumes \$764 billion in tax cuts over five years, including an extension of the 2001 and 2003 tax cuts for households earning less than \$250,000 annually, a three-year adjustment to prevent additional taxpayers from paying the alternative minimum tax and a permanent extension of the 2009 estate tax cuts. It also establishes reserve funds for health care reform and climate change legislation to reduce the nation's emission of carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/joint-fy2010-budget-resolution

9. Local Law Enforcement Hate Crimes Prevention Act of 2009

	H.R. 1913 · April 29, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 249 NAYs 175
	Passage of the bill that would expand federal hate crimes law to cover those based on sexual orientation, gender or disability. The bill would authorize \$5 million annually in fiscal 2010 and 2011 for grants to state, local and tribal law enforcement agencies to investigate and prosecute hate crimes. It would authorize unspecified sums in fiscal 2010 through 2012 for the Justice Department to hire additional law enforcement personnel to prevent and respond to federal hate crimes.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/local-law-enforcement-hate-crimes-prevention-act-2009

10. Credit CARD Act of 2009

	H.R. 627 · April 30, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 357 NAYs 70
	The legislation would impose restrictions on credit card company lending practices, including when companies could increase annual percentage interest rates retroactively on an existing balance. It expands a number of disclosure requirements for credit card companies and restricts the ability of credit card companies to change the terms of an account after it has been established.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/credit-card-act-2009

11. 21st Century Green High-Performing Public School Facilities Act

	H.R. 2187 · May 14, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 275 NAYs 155
	The 21st Century Green High-Performing Public Schools Facilities Act provides \$6.4 billion in direct investment for critical school repairs and to encourage energy efficiency. The bill also creates good jobs in the construction industry and stimulates local, state and regional economic activity during the current economic downturn.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/21st-century-green-high-performing-public-school-facilities-act>

12. FAA Reauthorization Act of 2009

H.R. 915 · May 21, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 277 NAYs 136

The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) reauthorization bill invests in technology and the nation's airports, creates good jobs and strengthen workers' rights.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/faa-reauthorization-act-2009>

13. Federal Employees Paid Parental Leave Act of 2009

H.R. 626 · June 4, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 258 NAYs 154

The bill provides four weeks of paid parental leave to federal employees to care for the birth or adoption of a child. Without the bill, federal workers must use accrued annual or sick leave if they want to receive pay for any of the time that they are out on parental leave. This policy is particularly difficult for newer, younger employees who have not accrued much leave or employees who have used up their leave.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/federal-employees-paid-parental-leave-act-2009>

14. American Clean Energy and Security Act of 2009

H.R. 2454 · June 26, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 219 NAYs 212

The American Clean Energy and Security Act would create a "cap-and-trade" system for limiting greenhouse gas emissions and set new requirements for electric utilities. It would require utilities to produce 15 percent of the nation's electricity from renewable sources by 2020, with another five percent energy savings from efficiency. It would set new emissions standards for coal-fired power plants, and new energy efficiency and water use standards for buildings and products. It would establish programs to assist energy consumers with higher utility bills as a result of the system. It also would create programs for electrical transmission lines, smart grid technologies, modernizing electricity infrastructure, reduction of emissions, increased energy efficiency, and carbon capture and sequestration. It maintains a diverse energy portfolio for the nation that includes renewable energy, fossil fuels, nuclear power and hydropower, while spurring investment in new energy technologies that will create jobs. It establishes an adjustment at the border for products that do not bear the same carbon costs and provides transition assistance for energy intensive, trade exposed industries.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/american-clean-energy-and-security-act-2009>

15. Department of Labor, HHS, and Education Appropriations Act, 2010

H.R. 3293 · July 24, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 264 NAYs 153

The House fiscal year 2010 spending bill for the departments of Labor, Health and Human Services, Education and related federal agencies provides funding for workforce development, public health and education programs. Most of the programs funded by the bill are experiencing unusually high demand for their services as a result of the recession.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/department-labor-hhs-and-education-appropriations-act-2010>

16. Supplemental Appropriations for FY2009 for the Consumer Assistance to Recycle and Save Program

H.R. 3435 · July 31, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 316 NAYs 109

The "cash-for-clunkers" bill provided an additional \$2 billion for the vehicle trade-in program, which offers vouchers worth up to \$4,500 toward the purchase of new vehicles to consumers who trade in their older, less-efficient models. The program triggered a major surge in new car sales, and helped hard-pressed dealers, manufacturers, suppliers and their workers. At the same time, the program will reduce oil consumption and greenhouse gas emissions by removing older, less efficient vehicles from the road and replacing them with new, higher-mileage vehicles.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/supplemental-appropriations-fy2009-consumer-assistance-recycle-and-save>

17. Corporate and Financial Institution Compensation Fairness Act of 2009

	H.R. 3269 · July 31, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 237 NAYs 185
	The House Corporate and Financial Institution Compensation Fairness Act provides a number of reforms to executive compensation practices at publicly traded companies, including banks and other financial companies receiving federal help under the Troubled Asset Relief Program (TARP) and other federal programs during the current economic downturn. Among other provisions, the bill would allow a company's shareholders to vote annually on executive compensation packages and on "golden parachute" compensation packages for outgoing executives in the event of a merger or acquisition.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/corporate-and-financial-institution-compensation-fairness-act-2009

18. Worker, Homeownership, and Business Assistance Act of 2009

	H.R. 3548 · November 5, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 403 NAYs 12
	With the numbers of long-term unemployed reaching record levels, the House passed legislation to provide 14 additional weeks of unemployment insurance benefits compensation for the long-term unemployed in every state and an additional six weeks for those who live in states with a three-month unemployment rate of 8.5% or higher. It passed Nov. 5, 2009, and was signed into law the following day.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/worker-homeownership-and-business-assistance-act-2009

19. Preservation of Access to Care for Medicare Beneficiaries and Pension Relief Act of 2010

	H.R. 3962 · November 7, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 220 NAYs 215
	The Affordable Health Care for America Act would expand health care coverage to 96% of Americans, rein in insurance company abuses, lower costs for families, businesses and the federal budget, and improve the quality of health care. It included a public health insurance option to lower costs and increase competition, required all but the smallest employers to provide their workers with coverage, or contribute to a fund to make it affordable for workers, and asked the wealthiest in this country to pay their fair share to fund health care.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/preservation-access-care-medicare-beneficiaries-and-pension-relief-act

20. Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act

	H.R. 4173 · December 11, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 223 NAYs 202
	The legislation overhauls the country's financial rules, creates a Consumer Financial Protection Agency, brings the financial derivatives market under federal regulation for the first time, imposes restrictions on credit ratings firms, improves investor protections and requires the registration of investment advisers of private pools of capital.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/dodd-frank-wall-street-reform-and-consumer-protection-act

21. The Jobs for Main Street Act

	H.R. 2847 · December 16, 2009
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 217 NAYs 212
	The financial crisis and recession created an 11 million jobs deficit. The Jobs for Main Street Act begins to address that by redirecting \$75 billion in unused bank bailout money—the Troubled Asset Relief Program (TARP)—to fund infrastructure and job investments; and provide additional emergency funding to help families who are suffering.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/house/jobs-main-street-act

SENATE

1. Amendment to Enact a National Right to Work Law

S.Amdt. 31 to S. 181 · January 22, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 67 NAYs 30

Sen. Jim Demint (R-S.C.) offered an amendment to the Lilly Ledbetter Fair Pay Act that would have enacted a national "right-to-work" law, blocking union-security clauses which ensure that all workers who receive the benefits of union representation and collective bargaining agreements share the costs of maintaining the union. A motion to table (kill) the amendment was agreed to on Jan. 22, 2010.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-enact-national-right-work-law>

2. Amendment to Prohibit Project Labor Agreements

S.Amdt. 34 to S. 181 · January 22, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 59 NAYs 38

Sen. David Vitter (R-La.) offered an amendment to the Lilly Ledbetter Fair Pay Act that would have codified President George W. Bush's Executive Order prohibiting the use of project labor agreements (PLA's) on federally assisted construction projects. If the amendment had passed it would have pre-empted President Barack Obama's Executive Order encouraging the use of PLA's. A motion to table (kill) the amendment was agreed to on Jan. 22, 2010.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-prohibit-project-labor-agreements>

3. The Lilly Ledbetter Fair Pay Act

S. 181 · January 22, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 61 NAYs 36

The Lilly Ledbetter Fair Pay Act restores longstanding protections against pay discrimination that were eliminated by the U.S. Supreme Court in its 2007 decision, Ledbetter v. Goodyear Tire and Rubber. Lilly Ledbetter, a Goodyear Tire Co. supervisor, did not learn that she was being paid substantially less than her male colleagues, in violation of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, until she retired after 19 years on the job. The Supreme Court ruled that Ledbetter lost the right to sue 180 days after she received her first paycheck. Prior to this decision, other courts had ruled that each paycheck started the 180-day clock over because each check was fresh evidence of discrimination.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/lilly-ledbetter-fair-pay-act>

4. Children's Health Insurance Program Reauthorization Act of 2009

H.R. 2 · January 29, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 66 NAYs 32

Since the Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP) was enacted in 1997 with broad bipartisan support, the number of uninsured children has dropped by one-third, even as the rate of uninsured adults has increased steadily. The CHIP reauthorization bill preserves coverage for more than 6 million children while extending coverage to nearly 4 million more uninsured children.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/childrens-health-insurance-program-reauthorization-act-2009>

5. American Recovery and Reinvestment Act of 2009

H.R. 1 · February 10, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 61 NAYs 37

As a first priority of the Obama administration and a key step toward rebuilding an economy that works for all Americans, the Senate passed the American Recovery and Reinvestment Act. The investment provisions of the bill are specifically targeted to creating and maintaining jobs, and make major investments in transportation, infrastructure, state Medicaid and other health care programs, education and housing assistance, and energy-efficiency projects.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/american-recovery-and-reinvestment-act-2009>

6. District of Columbia House Voting Rights Act of 2009

S. 160 · February 24, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 62 NAYs 34

Republicans filibustered the District of Columbia House Voting Rights Act, which would allow the delegate elected by the citizens of Washington, D.C., to vote in the House of Representatives. S. 160 would also increase the number of U.S. representatives from the state of Utah. U.S. citizens who live in the nation's capital serve in the armed forces, pay federal taxes and sit on federal juries, yet they have no voting representation in the U.S. Congress. The Senate voted to invoke cloture and end the filibuster.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/district-columbia-house-voting-rights-act-2009>

7. Confirmation of Hilda Solis for Secretary of Labor

February 24, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 80 NAYs 17

More than two months after being nominated, the Senate held a vote to confirm Hilda Solis as Secretary of Labor.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/confirmation-hilda-solis-secretary-labor>

8. Amendment to Prohibit Employee Notice of Rights

S.Amdt. 674 to H.R. 1105 · March 10, 2009

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 38 NAYs 59

During the debate on the omnibus spending bill, the Senate rejected an amendment by Sen. John Cornyn (R-Texas) that would have blocked an Obama Administration directive requiring federal contractors to post notices in their workplace explaining workers' rights.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-prohibit-employee-notice-rights>

9. Omnibus Appropriations Act, 2009

H.R. 1105 · March 10, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 62 NAYs 35

The omnibus spending bill combined nine funding bills for several federal agencies, including the Department of Labor and Department of Education. The bill included funding for critical labor, health and safety programs and would fund government operations through Sept. 30, 2009. The Senate voted to end a Republican filibuster.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/omnibus-appropriations-act-2009>

10. Amendment to Establish a Task Force to Cut Social Security, Medicare and Medicaid

S.Amdt. 835 to S.Con.Res. 13 · April 1, 2009

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 44 NAYs 54

During the budget debate, the Senate rejected an amendment by Sen. Judd Gregg (R-N.H.) to establish a task force to review our country's "long-term fiscal imbalances." The premise of this amendment was that entitlement programs, like Social Security, must be cut. Furthermore, Congress would be forced to consider any task force recommendations from the task force under Fast Track procedures (without any amendments), effectively outsourcing significant legislative recommendations to an outside body without accountability.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-establish-task-force-cut-social-security-medicare-and>

11. FY2010 Budget Resolution

S.Con.Res. 13 · April 2, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 55 NAYs 43

The Senate budget resolution increased discretionary spending by \$490 billion over five years—restoring funding to housing, education, job training, and safety and health care programs that had been consistently cut during the past eight years. The resolution also provided a reserve fund for health care reform, education reform and a "cap-and-trade" program to cut the nation's emissions of carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/fy2010-budget-resolution>

12. Amendment to Provide Foreclosure Relief

S.Amdt. 1014 to S. 896 · April 30, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 45 NAYs 51

During the debate on the Helping Families Save Their Homes Act, Sen. Richard Durbin (D-Ill.) offered an amendment that would have allowed bankruptcy judges to modify home mortgages on terms that could allow thousands of homeowners facing foreclosure to keep their homes. Many mortgage lenders have been slow or failed to modify existing loans, despite many borrowers receiving loans based on false, misleading and predatory lending practices.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-provide-foreclosure-relief>

13. Credit CARD Act of 2009

H.R. 627 · May 19, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 90 NAYs 5

The legislation would impose restrictions on credit card company lending practices, including when companies could increase annual percentage interest rates retroactively on an existing balance. It expands a number of disclosure requirements for credit card companies and restricts the ability of credit card companies to change the terms of an account after it has been established.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/credit-card-act-2009>

14. Supplemental Appropriations for FY2009 for the Consumer Assistance to Recycle and Save Program

H.R. 3435 · August 6, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 68 NAYs 31

The "cash-for-clunkers" bill provided an additional \$2 billion for the vehicle trade-in program, which offers vouchers worth up to \$4,500 toward the purchase of new vehicles to consumers who trade in their older, less-efficient models. The program triggered a major surge in new car sales, and helped hard-pressed dealers, manufacturers, suppliers and their workers. At the same time, the program will reduce oil consumption and greenhouse gas emissions by removing older, less efficient vehicles from the road and replacing them with new, higher-mileage vehicles.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/supplemental-appropriations-fy2009-consumer-assistance-recycle-and-save>

15. Confirmation of Sonia Sotomayor to the U.S. Supreme Court

August 6, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 68 NAYs 31

President Barack Obama nominated federal judge Sonia Sotomayor to be a U.S. Supreme Court associate justice. During her time on the federal bench, she demonstrated her understanding of the impact of the law on working families and consistently interpreted labor laws in the manner in which they were intended. As a federal judge, she enforced the rights of workers to be paid correct wages, to receive the health care benefits to which they were entitled and to be free from all types of discrimination. She also recognized that persecution for union activity can be a basis for granting asylum.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/confirmation-sonia-sotomayor-us-supreme-court>

16. Cloture Motion: Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act

H.R. 3590 · November 21, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 60 NAYs 39

The Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act expands coverage to more than 30 million Americans, puts new rules on insurance companies and provides subsidies to help middle- and low- income families and small business to purchase coverage through market exchanges. However, it falls short in several critical areas, including lacking a public health insurance plan option and a requirement that businesses pay their fair share. It also imposed a new tax on working families' benefits. (A corrections bill passed in March 2010 strengthened the fair share for business requirements and eliminated 85% of the tax on benefits.) Republicans filibustered the bill. On Nov. 21, 2009, the Senate invoked cloture on the motion to proceed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/cloture-motion-patient-protection-and-affordable-care-act>

17. Amendment to Reimport FDA-Approved Medicines

S.Amdt. 2793 to H.R. 3590 · December 15, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 51 NAYs 48

An amendment to the health care reform bill would give American consumers, pharmacists and drug wholesalers access to U.S. Food and Drug Administration-approved medicines currently sold in other major industrialized countries at a fraction of the U.S. price. The amendment needed 60 votes to pass but fell shy by nine votes.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-reimport-fda-approved-medicines>

18. Amendment Extending Unemployment Benefits and COBRA Health Insurance Subsidies

H.R. 3326 · December 19, 2009

Position Good for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 88 NAYs 10

This amendment to the Department of Defense Appropriations Act, 2010 (H.R. 3326) continued extended unemployment benefits and COBRA health insurance subsidies for the long-term jobless through Feb. 28, 2010. The programs were due to expire Dec. 31, 2009.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2009/senate/amendment-extending-unemployment-benefits-and-cobra-health-insurance>